

in our budding romance. Moreover, arbitration is not a viable alternative for settling such trading arguments, because it can take hours and cost both traders precious floor time, often a sacrifice of more money than the amount being disputed.

So, instead, we grudgingly agreed to split the loss. The pit had been too loud for anyone to hear correctly. My adversary left with his copy of the rejected trade notice, but not before calling me a "first-class bitch." At least he still thought of me as first class. But not enough to resume dating me. In fact, he told me afterward that whenever he looked at me, all he could think of was losing \$23,625.

Considering the overwhelming number of young men compared to the handful of women on the floor, it's surprising how very little of the old hanky-panky went on during my time on the trading floor. I suspect the guys were either too busy making big bucks or too tired to do anything but flirt.

I admit to having my share of admirers, most of whom proved eminently forgettable. A nice exception was my friend Roger Fenn from Merrill Lynch, a real gentle giant who took a protective interest in me and kept my podium stocked with candy bars. On the way back from an AMEX marketing presentation one day, on impulse, he bought all fifty balloons from a street vendor for twenty-five dollars and handed them to me. Then he left to do some errands. As I walked down the street, people approached me and asked if they were for sale. Naturally, I said "Of course," and sold them all, at two bucks apiece. One of the women in the marketing department had seen Roger buy them for me and was shocked at my callousness. "How can you do that to Roger?" she said, voicing her disapproval. "Okay, okay," I said, "I'll tell him." I did more than that. I handed him fifty dollars — half the profits. He beamed. "Atta girl!" After all, a trader is a trader.